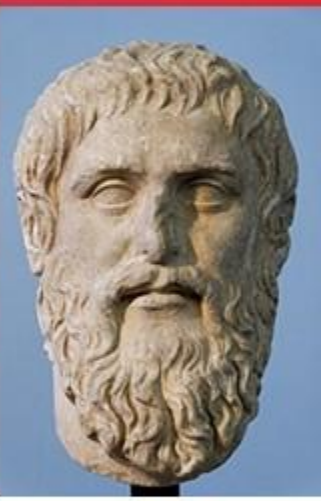
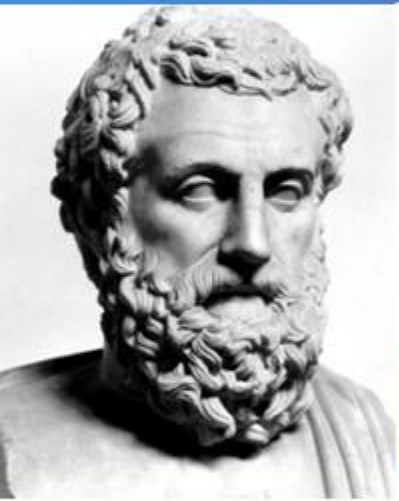


ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE



HUMAN VALUES

MODULE - 10

**BELIEFS AND TRAITS,
ROLE OF FAMILY**

CRITERIA FOR VALUES



If we say that we hold charity as a value, we are aspiring to be charitable, even at personal cost or we feel that value of charity is worth something to us.

But the idea of charity of another person may be very different than yours, and hence there is a **need for a criteria**.

Criteria define our values, or give them **specific meaning** to us, for example: helping others to be self-reliant, empowering others, helping others meet challenges.

Values are mostly **abstract concepts** and are defined further by **criteria**.

BELIEFS



Beliefs are the **convictions** that we **generally hold to be true**, usually without actual proof or evidence. They are often, but not always, connected to religion.

Beliefs are **basically assumptions** that we make about the world and our **values are drawn from those beliefs**.

Our **beliefs grow from** what we see, hear, experience, read and think about. From these things **we develop an opinion** that we hold to be true and unmovable at that time, but it **may vary from time to time**.

From our beliefs we derive our values. beliefs can either be correct or incorrect when compared with evidence, but nonetheless hold true for us.

- Beliefs are concepts that we hold to be true.
- Values are ideas that we hold to be important.

Beliefs and values determine our attitudes and opinions.

Sometimes beliefs become very strongly entrenched or emotional. In this way, **beliefs can influence our behaviors**, even our **thoughts**, in very powerful ways.

It is possible for our **beliefs and values** to **differ** over time as we encounter evidence or have experiences that challenge our previously held views. Conversely, **our beliefs and values can also be strengthened** by experience or evidence.

Values are the basis for our behavior and motivation. **Values are abstract, hierarchical and dynamic concepts** that essentially describe what we desire or seek to achieve.

VALUE

- ✓ Values are **stable long-lasting beliefs** about **what is important** to a person. They become standards by which people order their lives and make their choices.
- ✓ A **belief will develop into a value** when the **person's commitment to it grows** and they see it as being important.
- ✓ We can **categorise beliefs into different types of values**.
- ✓ A person **must be able to articulate** his/her values in order to make clear, rational, responsible and consistent decisions.

BELIEF

- ✓ A belief is an **idea that a person holds as being true**.
- ✓ A person can **base a belief upon** certainties (e.g. mathematical principles), probabilities or matters of faith.
- ✓ A **belief can come from different sources**, including:
 - i. a person's own experiences or experiments
 - ii. the acceptance of cultural and societal norms (e.g. religion)
 - iii. what other people say (e.g. education or mentoring).

Not all beliefs are values, but all values are beliefs.

ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

VALUES, MORALS AND ETHICS



You are a kid in the school. You see a bully who thinks he is the undisputed king. This **perception is a relative value**. But when his relative value supersedes the life value of another kid – or when the bully punches the other kid – this is wrong and must be stopped. **Relative values**, no matter how great, **cannot supersede the life value**.



You see the bully harassing the other kid. You **feel that this is wrong, indicating that you are moral**. Most people are moral – they know the difference between right and wrong.

You **see the bully harassing** another kid and you overcome the fear and embarrassment, and you **inform a teacher or** you may choose to **go to the aid** of the bullied kid yourself. Now, you are an **ethical** human being.

VIEW 1

Traits cause behavior. Traits are stable, internal, and natural in a person. A person would behave in a similar manner from one situation to the next.

VIEW 2

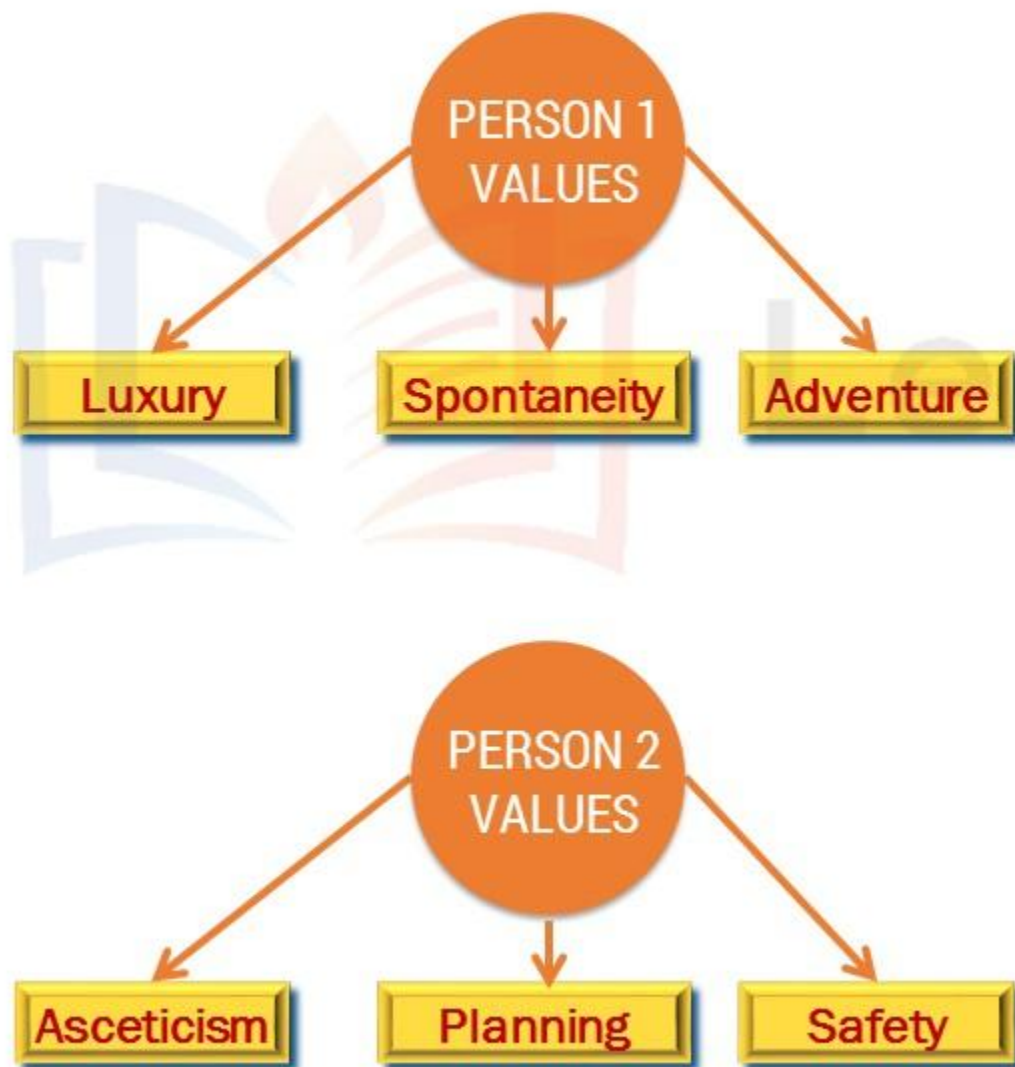
Behavior is greatly influenced by the current situation and not so much by the traits of a person. Behavior is changeable and flexible because no one person acted the same from one situation to the next.

Personal traits are **stable behavioural habits and physical or mental abilities**.

Both values and personal traits **are developed through** a combination of inborn instincts and influence of the environment.

Values direct behaviour, so they greatly influence development and manifestation of personal traits.

Cognitive values develop later than key behavioural traits; values follow the development of rational thought, while important behavioural traits are often manifested earlier in one's childhood.



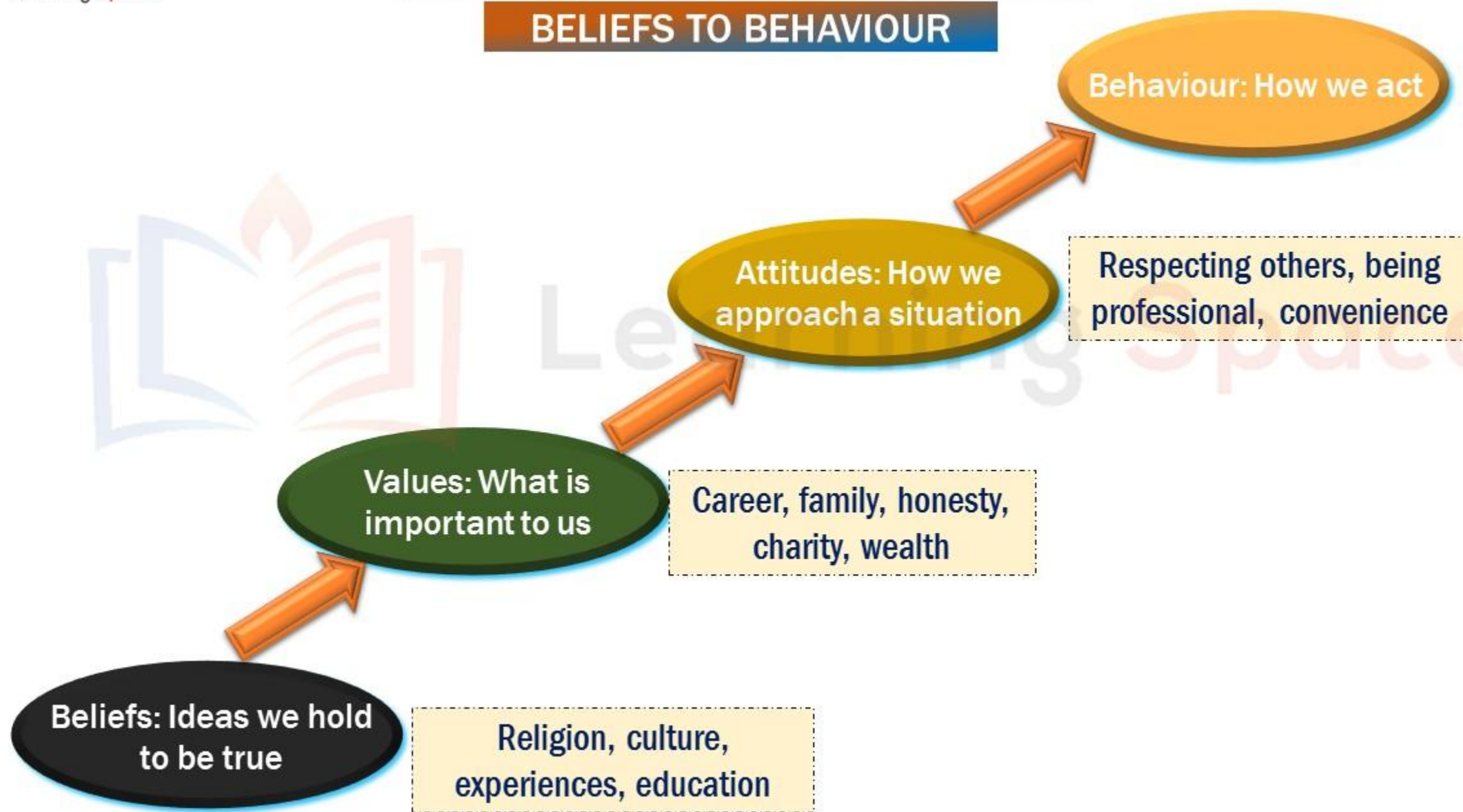
Crucial values determine a successful relationship and **attractive personal traits** are not necessarily related to values.

For example a person is intelligent, funny, warm, and confident. However, it does not mean that such a person will value what you value - and values are what relationships, both personal and professional, are built on or broken upon.

If the **values are not compatible**, the relationship may not last long, but if the **values are compatible**, the relationships has a fair chance of success.

ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

BELIEFS TO BEHAVIOUR



1

FAMILY INTERACTIONS

Parents and family have the most influence on a person's life. They are the one responsible for teaching us the difference between right and wrong. Thus, from the moment that we are born, they **become a role model for us**. What they do, we think as right and what they don't do, we think as wrong. Usually **what happens at home shapes a person's values and traits**.

For example:

- If at home the children have a high respect for their parents, then outside, those children might have a high respect for authority too.
- When at home the parents are always fighting and arguing with each other, the children might not believe in the commitment of marriage.



2

SOCIETAL INTERACTIONS

- Interacting with other people always has an effect on the person. Interacting with parents, teachers, classmates, relatives, colleagues, and neighbors is how we get influence from other people who in turn affect our values and traits.
- Whatever struggles a person might experience will also shape his traits and values. Thus, we can be strong or bitter if there is a certain situation that will make us change.



3

ROLE MODEL INTERACTIONS

People also become affected by the people around them: their teachers, their friends, relatives, neighbors, etc. Again this works on setting an example basis. Whatever is generally accepted, people think of it as right though sometimes it is wrong. The media also provides a great factor in shaping up a person's values and traits. From the television dramas, to celebrities, to music icons, people tend to follow what their idols/role models do.



VALUES COME FROM

During the bloody partition, a Sikh family saves a Muslim family from lynching by the mob.

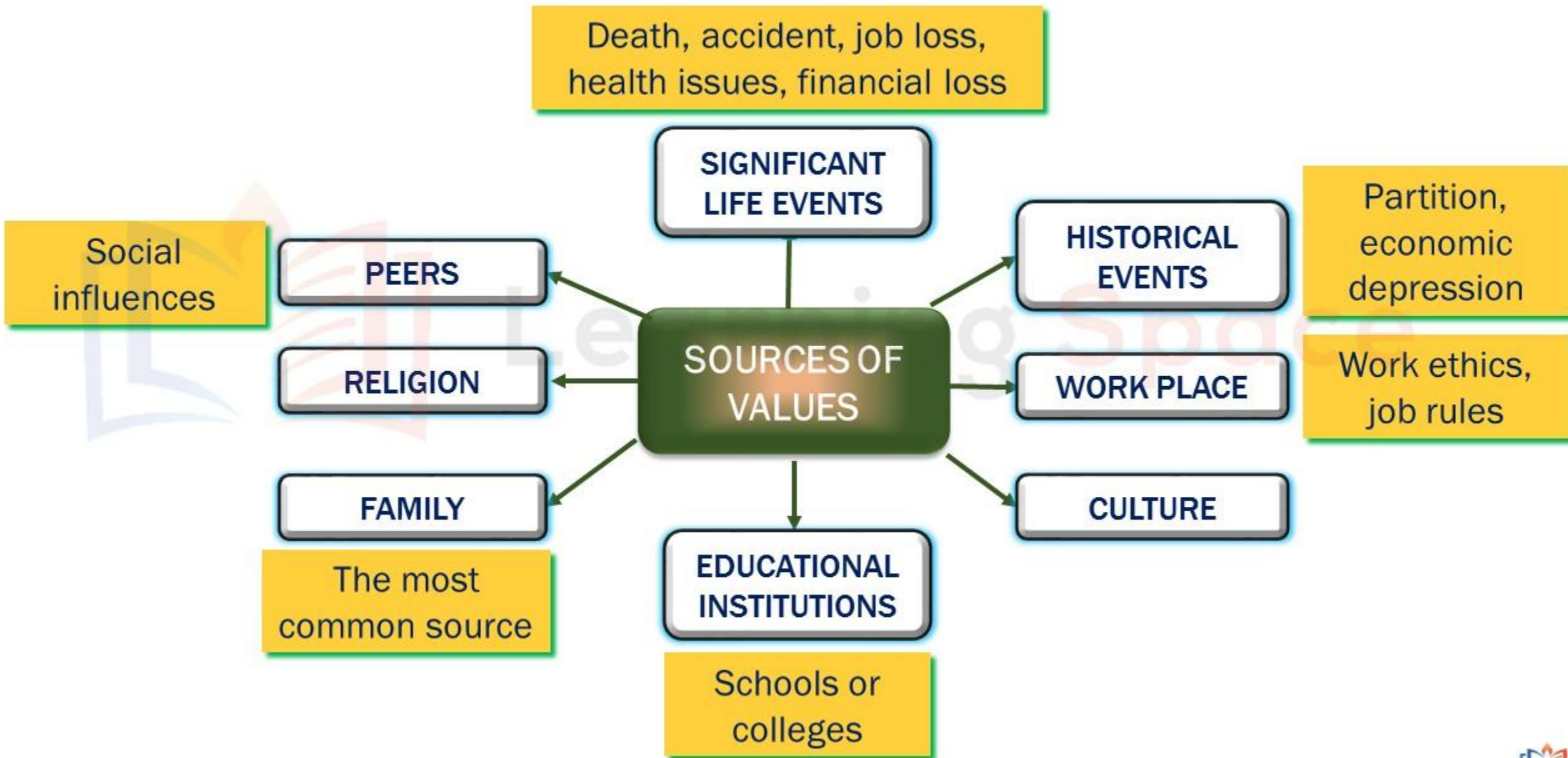


All the young members of a family participated in indiscriminate killing of people belonging to other faith.

A father who always wears a helmet while driving a two-wheeler or a seat belt while driving a car and follows traffic rules .



A father who believes that it is his decision to make on wearing protective gear while driving and following the traffic rules.



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